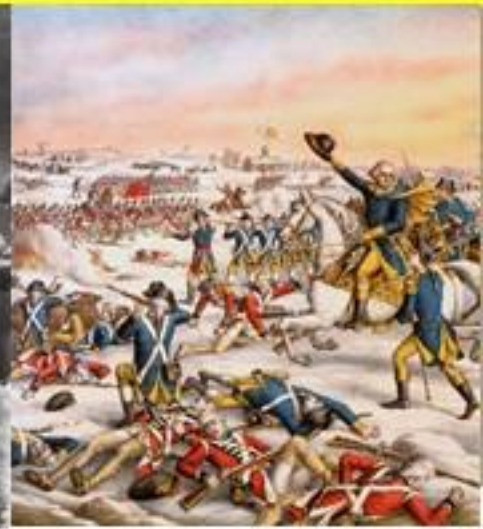


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 22

UNIFICATION OF ITALY-1

1 COLLAPSE OF THE ROMAN EMPIRE

- For centuries after the collapse of the Roman Empire, the Italian peninsula had been home to an odd group of independent small territorial states.
- These states were occasionally subject to foreign domination by larger states, including Spain, France, and the Holy Roman Empire early on and later, Bourbon and imperial France and the Hapsburgs of Austria.



2 RENAISSANCE PERIOD

- The idea of Italy as an entity, of Italian as a noble and beautiful language and of the common cultural roots of the Italian city states, however can be traced back to the renaissance period and even earlier.

3 FRENCH REVOLUTION AND NAPOLEONIC WARS

- The French revolution on 1789 and the Napoleonic wars gave impetus to the feeling of nationalism among the Italian people who shared same language, customs, mores and culture.



1 BACKGROUND OF ITALY

4 CONGRESS OF VIENNA

- 1 After the fall down of the Napoleonic empire, the four great powers of Europe (Britain, Austria, Prussia and Russia) maintained that Italy was not sufficiently strong or self-supporting to stand alone.
- 2 The arrangements were made in the Congress of Vienna which perpetuated the division of Italy and foreign rule which had existed previously.
- 3 The congress of Vienna gave no importance to the growing popular feelings of nationalism and guided by the tenets of balance of power and to maintain the legitimacy of the absolute monarchy.



1 BACKGROUND OF ITALY

4 CONGRESS OF VIENNA

4 The same was reflected in the case of Italy.

5 The only important territorial changes compared to the situation before 1789 was the annexation of the Venetian republic by Austria and of the former Genoese republic by Piedmont.

6 Metternich the chief architect of the congress of Vienna regarded Italy as merely a geographical expression: Austrian influence in the peninsula was augmented to act as a barrier to any new French invasion.



The various units in Italy were as follows

LOMBARDY AND VENETIA

- Both were placed under direct Austrian rule.

THE KINGDOM OF NAPLES AND SICILY (THE TWO SICILIES)

- Austrian arms were responsible for restoring the tyrant bourbon ruler king Ferdinand.
- He immediately concluded an offensive and defensive treaty with Austria.



THE PAPAL STATES

- The Papal States were ruled by pope.

THE DUCHIES OF PARMA, MODENA AND TUSCANY

- Austrian princes or persons friendly to Austria or related to the house of Hapsburg were made rulers.

PIEDMONT

- This included savoy, nice, genoa and the island of Sardinia.
- This was the only Italian state under Italian rule.



ITALY IN 1815



2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

1 TRADITION OF LOCALISM AND SEPARATISM

- 1 Though Italy formed a unity on the maps, there were many natural barriers, particularly mountain ranges, and too few roads.
- 2 This hindered concerted action in spite of the shared common culture and language there exist a great diversity among Italians at that time.
- 3 The northern provinces were rich and urbane while the southern provinces were relatively poor and rural.
- 4 There was an ostensible economic divide between the two. "Way of life" differed greatly between southern and northern Italy.
- 5 Parochial interests and general dissension seemed more feature of Italian life than united activity.



2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

1 TRADITION OF LOCALISM AND SEPARATISM

6 There was no standardization in the currencies, weights and measures, and other necessary aspects of organisation.

7 There has been no or little co-operation between different Italian states at that time.

8 Often local rulers had sacrificed national aspirations for self-interest and had sought foreign aid to help win their domestic quarrels.



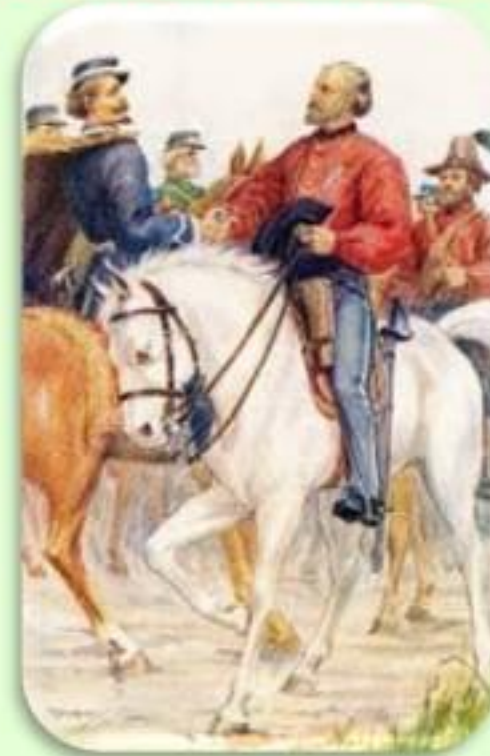
2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

2 AUTOCRATIC RULE

Local rulers and states (except piedmont) were vehemently opposed to the unification of Italy.

1 Because of their vested interests they were also opposed to the idea of popular revolution and ideals like limited government and democracy.

2 No Italian state had a parliament in government.



2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

3 DIFFERENT SCHOOL OF THOUGHTS

In Italy even among those who envisaged unification there exist various schools of thoughts.

1 Those who aimed unification of Italy differ stark in their ideology and methodologies.

2 During the period 1815-48 there were three main schools of thought on how to achieve unity, but all three groups disliked each other and had no wish to co-operate.



- ✓ For instance democratic republicans like Mazzini wanted to abolish monarchies and to establish a democratic republic.
- ✓ Likewise there were liberal monarchies like Cavour who wanted unified Italy as constitutional monarchy.
- ✓ Similarly, the third dominant school of thought wanted Italy to be federal state under a reformed Papacy.



2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

4 THE ROMAN QUESTION

The Pope was the temporal head of central Italy.

- 1 Loyal Catholics in Italy but by France and Austria supports his rule over the Papal States.
- 2 The Papal States constituted a wedge between the northern and southern parts of Italy.
- 3 The Pope was opposed to any movement or ideology that threatened his authority.



2 BARRIERS TO ITALIAN UNIFICATION

5 PRESENCE OF AUSTRIA

Austria was an important conservative catholic power in Europe at that time.

1 Metternich, the Austrian minister was the chief architect of the congress of Vienna which promoted "old order".

2 This state had considerable influence in Italy after 1815, except in piedmont, and was the chief barrier to the aspirations of Italian nationalists.



Metternich

1 GROWTH OF NATIONALISM

The American and French revolution gave impetus to the feeling of nationalism in Europe.

1 Italy was also affected by these romantic revolutions.

2 Napoleonic wars and dismantling of old boundaries by the conquests of Napoleon along with the homogenous civil codes further accentuated the feeling of nationalism.



2 PRESENCE OF FOREIGN POWERS

An increased hatred for the foreign powers, whose presence in the Italy served as perpetual reminder of the humiliating situation of Italy.

3 FREE TRADE

The trade and commerce was severely affected by the internal customs within and among Italian states.

Some of the Italian thinkers like Domenico Romagnosi were of the view that the abolition of customs frontiers in Italy and adoption of free trade as a step to Italian unity.

4 CULTURAL AND LITERARY WORKS

Certain men of letters helped to inspire the people to resist the tyranny of foreign rule.

Notable contributors were Vittorio Alferi, Giacomo Leopardi and Alessandro Manzoni.



Romagnosi



Alferi



Leopardi

3 FACTORS PROMOTING ITALIAN UNIFICATION

5 ACTIVITIES OF SECRET SOCIETIES

The clandestine societies which envisaged Italian unification played a dynamic role in the process.

- 1 These societies were important in giving Italians training in how to fight for their rights.



- 2 **CARBONARI:** The most prominent among these were Carbonari.

- ✓ This was the so-called society of charcoal-burners which was originated in Naples.
- ✓ At first it was an association for mutual assistance among officers of lower rank.
- ✓ After 1811 its activities became increasingly political.
- ✓ It aimed to expel the Austrians from Italy and played an active part in the revolution of 1820-21 and 1831.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

For Information:

info.learningspacedigital@gmail.com

Visit us at:

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